

Scarcity vs. Abundance Thinking

As long as you believe that only lucky or special people can become millionaires, you will never become one yourself. You might think of all the different reasons why you could never build wealth, telling yourself, *I'm just an ordinary person*; or *I'm not smart enough, attractive enough, or talented enough*; or *I don't have enough opportunities, advantages, or connections*. Focusing only on your limitations is what I call *scarcity thinking*. It's the voice in your head that says, *There are a limited number of opportunities, and I didn't get my chance*. The opposite of that is *abundance thinking*, which says, *There's enough opportunity to go around*. And that's the mind-set of every millionaire I've ever talked to.

People who are winning financially see opportunity around every corner. They know a rising tide raises all ships, so they aren't concerned when they see other people building wealth. They know there's enough opportunity for everyone, so they aren't threatened by someone else's success. Now, let's contrast that to scarcity thinkers. They only see limitations, usually looking at others' success with a little jealousy and contempt. They walk around with a "poor me" way of thinking, always listing the reasons for why they can't get ahead. They feel victimized, as though other people are gobbling up all the opportunities that would otherwise make them rich. Scarcity thinkers can't see the opportunities around them because they've never been taught that those opportunities are there for *them* too, not just for other people.

If that's you, you've got to change that mind-set right now. Maybe life has dealt you a hard hand, and maybe you've gotten knocked down more times than you can count. I get that, and many of the millionaires we studied have had those kinds of experiences, too. But at the end of the day, you've been lied to. How? People have told you that you can't do it, that success is not for you. You've been surrounded by people who are trying to hold you back. But you don't have to believe the lies; you get to *choose*